Feeling the heat

Some snakes have special gaps around their lips that are sensitive to heat. These are called heat pits. They are used to detect warm-blooded animal prey.

This emerald tree boa has lots of heat pits along its lips.



Double vision

A chameleon can move one eye, on its own, without moving the other. This means that it can look in two different directions at the same time. It can use one eye to hunt insects, and the other to look out for attackers.

Reptile file

- Snakes do not have ears on the outside. They "hear" vibrations as they travel through their jawbones and into their inner ears.
- The organ in snakes and lizards that "tastes" their environment is called the Jacobson's organ.